

Absolutely — **what** is a very useful grammar/polyfunctionality target because your passage uses it here:

> “Another thing she enjoys is sharing **what she grows** with other people.”

Here **what** means:

> **the thing(s) that**

It introduces a fused relative clause: **what she grows** = the things that she grows.

Word family / grammar family: **what**

Base form: what

Part of speech / function: interrogative pronoun (疑問代名詞) / interrogative determiner (疑問限定詞) / fused relative pronoun (融合關係代名詞) / exclamative determiner (感嘆限定詞)

Unlike a lexical word such as *garden* or *colour*, **what** is mainly a grammar/polyfunctionality word.

Your source sentence:

> “Another thing she enjoys is sharing **what she grows** with other people.”

Meaning in your passage: **what + clause** = the thing(s) that —的東西 /的事物

Here:

> **what she grows**

means:

> **the things that she grows**

繁體中文：

她所種的東西 / 她種出來的東西

Natural translation:

> “Another thing she enjoys is sharing what she grows with other people.”

「她另外也很享受的一件事，就是把**自己種出來的東西**分享給別人。」

So here:

> **what = the thing(s) that**

This is **not a question word** in your sentence.

1. **what = asking about a thing / information — 甚麼**

The core interrogative-pronoun use.

Practice 1

> “**What** is that?”

「那是**甚麼**？」

Practice 2

> “What happened?”

「發生了**甚麼事**？」

what = 用來詢問某件事、某個東西、情況或資訊是甚麼

2. **what + noun = which/what kind of thing — 甚麼……；哪種……**

Here **what** is an interrogative determiner.

Practice 3

> “**What plants** does she grow?”

「她種**甚麼植物**？」

Practice 4

> “What colour are the flowers?”

「這些花是**甚麼顏色**？」

what + noun = 詢問某類人 / 事物的身分、種類、性質等

Common:

- * what time
- * what colour
- * what reason
- * what kind
- * what size

3. **what + clause = the thing(s) that —的東西 / 事情**

This is your exact source use.

Practice 5 — Original

> “She enjoys sharing **what she grows**.”

「她喜歡分享**自己種出來的東西**。」

Practice 6

> “Take **what you need**.”

「拿走**你需要的東西**。」

Practice 7

> “I understand what you mean.”

「我明白**你的意思 / 你想表達的事情**。」

what + clause = the thing(s) that + clause

This is often called a **fused relative construction** because **what** contains both:

- * the noun idea (“thing”)
- * the relative connector (“that”)

4. **what + clause = that which / whatever thing — 所.....的事；所.....之物**

A more formal Chinese rendering of the same grammar.

Practice 8

> “What matters most is honesty.”

「****最重要的是誠實。**」

Literally:

> ****the thing that matters most****

Practice 9

> “What she said surprised everyone.”

「****她所說的話令所有人都很驚訝。**」

****what-clause = 整個「所.....的事 / 物」可在句中作主語、受詞或補語****

5. ****what-clause as subject —這件事 / 所.....的事****

Practice 10

> “****What he did**** was wrong.”

「****他所做的事是錯的。**」

Practice 11

> “What makes her happy is sharing with others.”

「****令她開心的事情是和別人分享。**」

****what-clause as subject = 整個 what 子句作句子的主語****

6. ****what-clause as object —的東西 / 事情****

Your source belongs here.

Practice 12

> “I like ****what you made****.”

「我喜歡****你做的東西**。」

Practice 13

> “She remembers what the teacher said.”

「她記得**老師說過的話**。」

what-clause as object = 整個 what 子句作動詞受詞

7. **what-clause after be —的是.....**

Practice 14

> “This is **what I wanted**.”

「這就是**我想要的東西**。」

Practice 15

> “That is what I mean.”

「那就是**我的意思**。」

be + what-clause = 說明某事物的內容 / 真正所指

8. **what + subject + be like? —是怎樣的？**

A major interrogative construction.

Practice 16

> “**What is the garden like?**”

「這個花園**是怎樣的**？」

Practice 17

> “What was your teacher like?”

「你的老師**是怎樣的人**？」

what is X like? = 詢問某人 / 某物的特徵、性格、外觀或整體情況

Important:

This is ****not**** asking:

> “What does X like?”

Completely different.

9. ****what does X look like? —看起來怎樣？****

Practice 18

> “****What does the plant look like?****”

「這棵植物****看起來怎樣****？」

Practice 19

> “What does the new building look like?”

「新建築物****外觀怎樣****？」

****what does X look like? = 詢問外觀****

Contrast:

* what is X like? = 整體特徵

* what does X look like? = 外表

10. ****what...for? = why / for what purpose — 為甚麼；作甚麼用途****

A common construction.

Practice 20

> “****What is this tool for?****”

「這件工具是****做甚麼用的****？」

Practice 21

> “What did you buy that for?”

「你買那個**做甚麼 / 為甚麼買**？」

****what...for? = 詢問目的或用途****

Often equivalent to:

> why?

but can sound more focused on purpose.

11. ****what about + noun/gerund? —呢？；怎麼樣？****

A very common conversational expression.

Practice 22

> “****What about**** the smaller plants?”

「那些較小的植物**呢**？」

Practice 23

> “What about growing herbs on the balcony?”

「在露台種香草**怎麼樣**？」

****what about...? = 提出話題、詢問情況、建議或考慮某個選項****

This is a fixed expression, so I would flag it rather than treat it as a bare-word sense.

12. ****what if + clause? — 如果.....怎麼辦 / 會怎樣？****

Practice 24

> “****What if**** it rains tomorrow?”

「如果明天下雨**怎麼辦**？」

Practice 25

> “What if the plant does not grow?”

「如果植物長不起來**怎麼辦**？」

****what if...? = 詢問某個假設情況可能造成甚麼結果****

13. ****what else = 還有甚麼****

Practice 26

> **“**What else** does she grow?”**

「她**還種甚麼**？」

Practice 27

> **“What else do we need?”**

「我們**還需要甚麼**？」

****what else = 除了已提及內容之外，還有甚麼****

14. ****what kind/type/sort of + noun — 甚麼種類的****

Practice 28

> **“**What kind of flowers** does she grow?”**

「她種**甚麼種類的花**？」

Practice 29

> **“What type of soil is best?”**

「****哪種類型的泥土**最好？**」

****what kind/type/sort of = 詢問類別、種類或性質****

15. ****what + noun! (感嘆) — 多麼……！；真是……！****

Now ****what**** introduces an exclamation.

Practice 30

> “**What a beautiful garden!**”

「**多麼漂亮的花園啊！ / 這花園真漂亮！**」

Practice 31

> “What lovely flowers!”

「**多漂亮的花啊！**」

Pattern:

> **What + a/an + adjective + singular countable noun!**

> **What + adjective + plural/uncountable noun!**

16. **what a/an + noun = 真是個.....；多麼.....**

Practice 32

> “**What a surprise!**”

「**真令人驚訝！ / 真是個驚喜！**」

Practice 33

> “What a pity!”

「**真可惜！**」

what a... = 強烈表達驚訝、欣賞、遺憾等情緒

17. **what with A and B (較口語 / 文學) — 因為又.....又.....；加上.....**

A genuine but secondary construction.

Practice 34

> “**What with** work and family responsibilities, she has little free time.”

「**又要工作，又要處理家庭責任**，她幾乎沒有空閒時間。」

Practice 35

> “What with the rain and the cold, we stayed indoors.”

「**又下雨又冷**，所以我們留在室內。」

what with A and B = 因為多個因素共同作用

Register: informal/literary; secondary.

18. **what of...? (較正式) — 那……又怎樣？；至於……呢？**

Practice 36

> “**What of** the remaining plants?”

「那**剩下的植物呢**？」

Practice 37

> “What of those who disagree?”

「那**不同意的人又怎樣呢**？」

what of...? = 提出一個尚未處理的人 / 問題，問「那……呢？」

Formal/literary.

19. **what = approximately / whatever amount in expressions like “what little...” — 僅有的……**

A useful advanced construction.

Practice 38

> “She shared **what little food she had**.”

「她把自己**僅有的一點食物**也分享了。」

Practice 39

> “He spent what little money remained.”

「他花掉了**僅剩的一點錢**。」

what little/few + noun = 某人所擁有的少量全部

Advanced but established.

20. **what's more = moreover / in addition — 而且；此外**

A common discourse expression.

Practice 40

> “The garden is beautiful and, **what's more**, useful.”

「這個花園很漂亮，**而且**也很實用。」

Practice 41

> “The course is free; what's more, it is online.”

「這個課程免費，**此外**還是網上課程。」

what's more = 再補充一項更進一步的資訊；而且 / 此外

Important distinction: **what vs which**

This is one of the biggest learner contrasts.

what

asks from an open or unspecified range:

> “What flowers do you grow?”

「你種甚麼花？」

which

chooses from a known/limited set:

> “Which flower do you prefer, the rose or the jasmine?”

「玫瑰和茉莉，你比較喜歡哪一種？」

So:

> **what = 開放式詢問**

> **which = 在已知選項中選擇**

Important distinction: **what vs that**

This is crucial for your source.

what she grows

= **the things that she grows**

You cannot normally say:

> *the things what she grows* ❌

because **what** already contains the idea of “the thing(s)”.

But:

> **the plants that she grows** ✅

So:

> what = the thing(s) that

> that = relative marker after an expressed noun

Important distinction: **what vs which in relative clauses**

what

does not take an explicit antecedent:

> “I know what she grows.”

which

normally refers back to an explicit noun:

> “She grows roses, which need plenty of sunlight.”

So:

> **what** = fused antecedent + relative word

> **which** = refers back to an earlier noun

Important distinction: **what** vs **whatever**

what

= the thing(s) that / what?

whatever

can mean:

* anything that;

* no matter what.

> “Take what you need.”

= 拿你需要的東西。

> “Take whatever you need.”

= 你需要甚麼都可以拿。

Whatever is broader and more unrestricted.

Important distinction: **what** vs **how**

what

asks about identity/content.

> “What happened?”

how

asks about manner/state.

> “How did it happen?”

So:

> what = 甚麼

> how = 怎樣

Important distinction: **What is she like? vs What does she like?**

Completely different.

What is she like?

= 她是怎樣的人？

What does she like?

= 她喜歡甚麼？

This is one of the most important English learner contrasts.

Important distinction: **What does it look like? vs What is it like?**

What does it look like?

= 外觀怎樣？

What is it like?

= 整體感覺 / 特徵怎樣？

Example:

> “What does the garden look like?”

> → 問外觀。

> “What is the garden like?”

> → 問整體特色、大小、氣氛等。

Important distinction: ****what for vs why****

****why****

asks reason:

> “Why did you buy it?”

****what...for****

often asks purpose:

> “What did you buy it for?”

Often both can translate 「為甚麼」, but ****what for**** more readily points to intended use/purpose.

Important distinction: ****what about vs how about****

They overlap strongly in suggestions:

> “What about planting herbs?”

> “How about planting herbs?”

Both:

「種香草怎麼樣？」

But ****what about**** is also very common for bringing up a missing topic:

> “What about the smaller plants?”

「那些較小的植物呢？」

Important distinction: ****what if vs if****

****if****

introduces a condition:

> “If it rains, we’ll stay inside.”

what if

asks about consequences of a hypothetical condition:

> “What if it rains?”

「如果下雨怎麼辦？」

Important distinction: **what a... vs how...**

Both form exclamations.

What a beautiful garden!

How beautiful the garden is!

Both can mean:

「這花園真漂亮！」

But grammar differs:

> what + noun phrase

> how + adjective/adverb

Important distinction: **what she grows vs the plants she grows**

These are semantically close:

> **what she grows**

> = 她種的東西

> **the plants she grows**

> = 她種的植物

But **what** is broader. It could include:

* flowers

* herbs

* vegetables

* fruit

It does not explicitly repeat the noun **plants**.

Grammar note: **what-clause** can be singular in agreement

A whole **what-clause** is often treated as singular when referring to one situation/idea:

> “What he said **was** surprising.”

「他說的話很令人驚訝。」

But when the complement clearly refers to plural things, plural agreement can sometimes arise depending on structure:

> “What we need **are** more chairs.”

This is an advanced agreement issue; for learners, focus first on the clause functioning as a noun phrase.

Grammar / function sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory is:

- * **what — question pronoun** = 甚麼
- * **what + noun** = 甚麼..... / 哪種.....
- * **what + clause** =的東西 / 事情
- * **what-clause as subject** = 所.....的事
- * **what-clause as object** =的東西 / 內容
- * **be + what-clause** =就是.....
- * **what is X like?** = X 是怎樣的？
- * **what does X look like?** = X 看起來怎樣？
- * **what...for?** = 作甚麼用 / 為甚麼
- * **what about...?** =呢 /怎麼樣
- * **what if...?** = 如果.....怎麼辦
- * **what else** = 還有甚麼
- * **what kind/type/sort of** = 甚麼種類的
- * **what + noun!** = 多麼..... / 真是.....
- * **what with A and B** = 因為又.....又.....
- * **what of...?** = 至於.....呢
- * **what little/few...** = 僅有的少量.....
- * **what's more** = 而且 / 此外

Master comparison

Form / pattern	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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what — interrogative pronoun	用來詢問某件事、某物、情況或資訊是甚麼
what + noun	詢問某類人 / 事物的身分、種類、性質等
what + clause	表示「.....的東西 / 事情」，相當於 the thing(s) that
what-clause as subject	整個「所.....的事 / 物」作句子主語
what-clause as object	整個「.....的東西 / 事情」作動詞受詞
be + what-clause	說明某事物真正的內容 / 所指
what is X like?	詢問 X 的整體特徵、性格、狀況
what does X look like?	詢問 X 的外觀
what...for?	詢問某物用途或某行動目的
what about...?	提出話題、詢問情況或提出建議
what if...?	詢問某個假設情況發生時會有甚麼結果
what else	除了已提內容之外，還有甚麼
what kind/type of	詢問類別或種類
what a/an...!	用來強烈感嘆某人 / 某事物
what with A and B	因多個因素共同作用；又.....又.....
what of...?	提出尚未處理的人 / 問題；至於.....呢
what little/few...	某人僅有的少量全部
what's more	在前述內容上再補充一項；而且 / 此外

For your original sentence

> “Another thing she enjoys is sharing ****what she grows**** with other people.”

The exact meaning is:

****what she grows = the things that she grows = 她所種的東西 / 她種出來的東西****

So naturally:

> ****「她另外也很享受的一件事，就是把自己種出來的東西分享給別人。」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****What does she grow?**** → 她種甚麼？
- > ****what she grows**** → 她所種的東西
- > ****what + noun**** → 甚麼.....
- > ****what vs which**** → 開放式詢問 vs 已知選項中選擇
- > ****what vs that**** → the thing(s) that vs 關係代名詞
- > ****What is she like?**** → 她是怎樣的人？
- > ****What does she like?**** → 她喜歡甚麼？
- > ****what about**** →呢 / 怎麼樣

> ****what if**** → 如果.....怎麼辦

> ****what a beautiful garden!**** → 多麼漂亮的花園！